

UPSC Mains Answer Evaluation Report

Comprehensive AI-Generated Assessment

Score Summary

Mode: critical

9/15 Total Score	General Studies Paper I Paper	15 Question Marks
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Detailed Scorecard (2+9+3+1 = 15)

Introduction

1.25/2

Clear, concise intro establishing time (March 1942), key personality (Sir Stafford Cripps), and primary purpose (securing Indian WWII cooperation).

Strengths:

- + Mentions exact month/year and details of Sir Stafford Cripps' official designations.

Areas to Improve:

- Lacks a clear thesis statement connecting wartime compulsion with British constitutional concessions.
Suggested approach: "State clearly that the Cripps Mission was a reluctant British attempt to offer post-war constitutional concessions in exchange for immediate Indian wartime cooperation amidst deteriorating military conditions in SE Asia."

Body

The body covers all key aspects required by the prompt—reasons for dispatch, main proposals, and stakeholder-wise failure reasons. However, it lacks visual aids and omits certain critical political groups (Hindu Mahasabha, Liberals) and specific electoral mechanisms.

Strengths:

- + Categorized reasons for failure by political entity (INC, Muslim League, Depressed Classes, Sikhs).
- + Accurate identification of Allied international pressure (Roosevelt, Chiang Kai-shek) and Labour Party dynamics.

Areas to Improve:

- Absence of visual presentation (map or schematic diagram) depicting the geopolitical threat or constitutional flow.

Suggested approach: "A map showing Japanese advance in Rangoon/Burma or a flowchart showing interim vs post-war proposals of Cripps Mission."

- Incomplete coverage of political stakeholders who rejected the offer.

Suggested approach: "Hindu Mahasabha rejected it fearing division of India ('Akhand Bharat'); Liberals like Sapru and Jayakar opposed non-accession clauses and defence retention."

- Interim governance vs Post-war promises distinction

Suggested approach: "Explicitly contrast what Cripps offered immediately (Interim control with Governor-General veto and defense in British hands) versus post-war promises (Dominion status, Constituent Assembly)."

Conclusion

1.75/3

Appropriate conclusion linking the failure of constitutional negotiations to the immediate escalation into the Quit India Movement.

Strengths:

- + Direct link between Cripps failure and the launch of Quit India Movement on 8th August 1942 at Gowalia Tank, Bombay.

Presentation

0.75/1

Neat handwriting, structured headings in boxes, and clean margins. Deducted points for missing visual diagrams/maps.

Answer Sheet - Page 1

Examiner Comments

1. Marks Awarded

Contextual introduction identifying Sir Stafford Cripps, timing (March 1942), and the core objective of obtaining Indian war support.

2. Marks Awarded

Solid points covering Japanese military advances in Southeast Asia, Allied international pressure, and domestic Labour party dynamics in Britain.

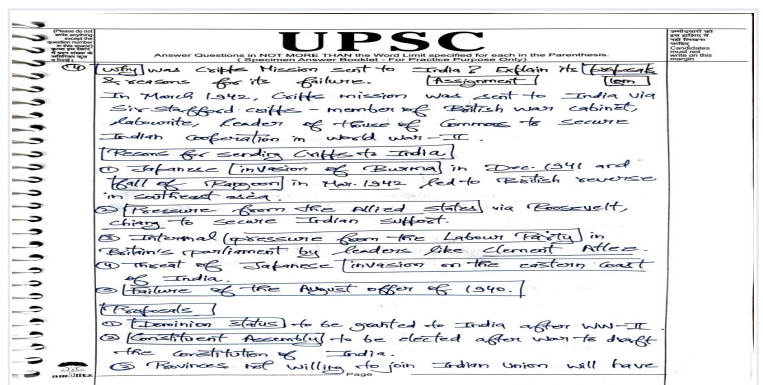
Examiner Comments (continued)

3. Missing Depth

"Pressure from the Allied states via Roosevelt, Chiang to secure Indian support."

Include broader geopolitical context such as USSR's pressure and Indian exclusion from the Atlantic Charter to add analytical depth.

Suggested approach: "Mention pressure from USA (Roosevelt), China (Chiang Kai-shek), USSR (Stalin), and the discontent over India's exclusion..."



Answer Sheet - Page 2

Examiner Comments

1. Marks Awarded

Well-structured bullet points capturing key constitutional provisions like Dominion Status, non-accession clause, and defence retention.

2. Unclear/Vague

""Post-dated cheque" - Gandhi."

Quote is truncated. Historical accuracy demands the full statement made by Mahatma Gandhi.

Suggested approach: "Write: Mahatma Gandhi famously described the proposals as 'a post-dated cheque on a crashing/failing bank'."

3. Missing Depth

"Depressed classes - Fear of getting dominated..."

Omitted perspectives of Hindu Mahasabha and Liberals (Tej Bahadur Sapru) who opposed the non-accession clause as a threat to national unity ('Akhand Bharat').

Suggested approach: "Add: Hindu Mahasabha & Liberals rejected the plan as the option for provincial autonomy/secession threatened the integri..."

UPSC	
Answer Questions in NOT MORE THAN the Word Limit specified for each in the Parenthesis. (Specimen Answer Booklet - For Practice Purpose Only)	
(Please do not write anything except the question number in this space. You are not to write anything on this page.)	उम्मीदवारों को इस कॉपी में कुछ लिखना नहीं चाहिए। Candidates must not write on this margin.
the right to secede. ④ Constitution of a Commission for safeguarding the interest of minorities. ⑤ <u>Princely states</u> not willing to join the Indian dominion can secede and have a <u>separate constitution</u>. ⑥ Governor General to retain the veto powers and defence, foreign affairs. <u>Reasons for Failure</u> ① <u>INC</u> - as it ignored INC's demand of <u>complete independence</u>. The provision of provinces & princely states to secede was <u>against the principle of National unity</u>. ② <u>"Post-dated cheque"</u> - Gandhi. <u>"Preserving autocratic powers"</u> - Nehru. ③ <u>Princely states</u> represented by nominees instead of elected representatives. ④ <u>Muslim League</u> - as Lacking explicit provision for the creation of Pakistan. ⑤ Did not liked the idea of Indian union. ⑥ <u>Depressed classes</u> - Fear of getting dominated by upper-caste Hindus after partition. ⑦ <u>Sikhs</u> - Fear of losing Punjab after partition.	

Examiner Comments

1. Marks Awarded

Good critical observation on Linlithgow and Churchill's lack of genuine intention to transfer actual power to a cabinet-style interim government.

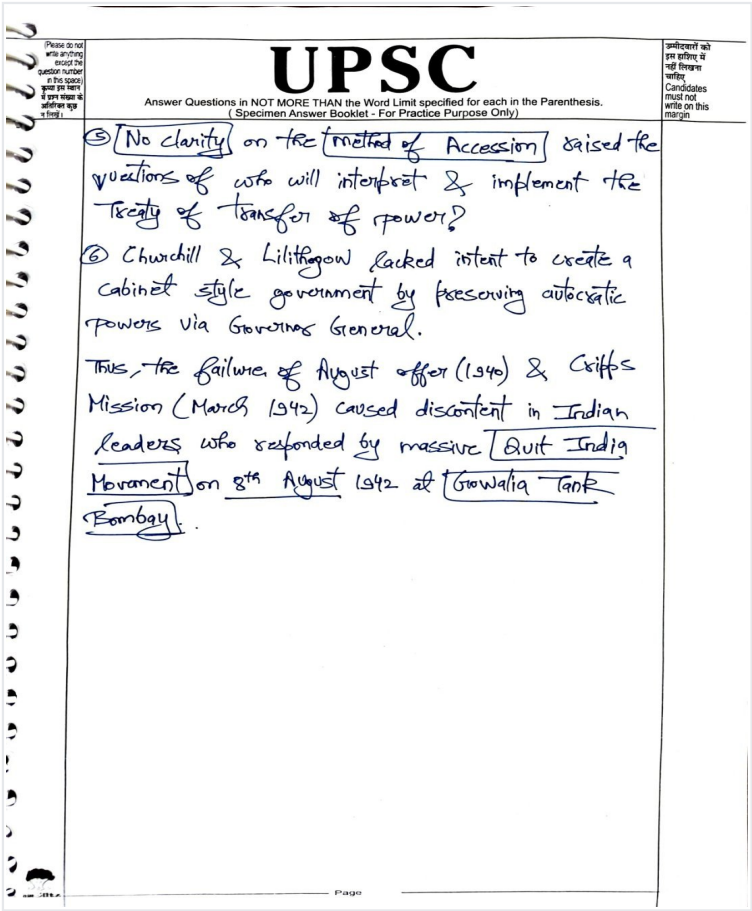
2. Poor Structure

GS-1 History answers require spatial representation or schematic diagrams where applicable. A map showing Japanese advance towards India's eastern border would strengthen the answer.

Suggested approach: "Draw a simple map of South-East Asia and Eastern India depicting Rangoon/Burma fall and Japanese naval threat in the Bay..."

3. Marks Awarded

Strong conclusion linking the failure of constitutional negotiations directly to the launch of the Quit India Movement on 8th August 1942 at Gowalia Tank.



Personalized Improvement Strategy

Performance Summary

The answer exhibits strong structural alignment with the question, addressing why Cripps Mission was sent, its proposals, and reasons for failure. However, it lacks visual aids (maps/diagrams), omits key stakeholder views (Hindu Mahasabha, Liberals), and truncates famous historical quotes. Incorporating spatial diagrams and complete technical details will push the score above 60%.

Key Strengths

- + Clear heading-subheading structure matching all sub-parts of the prompt.
- + Good point-wise presentation with neat handwriting and highlighted keywords.
- + Accurate chronology linking failure directly to the Quit India Movement (8th August 1942, Gowalia Tank).

Critical Weaknesses

- Lack of visual presentation (maps/flowcharts) which is essential for GS-1 History questions.
- Truncated quotes and minor omissions in technical electoral mechanisms (e.g., proportional representation for Constituent Assembly).
- Incomplete stakeholder coverage under reasons for failure (omitted Hindu Mahasabha, Liberals, and Depressed Classes details).

Study Recommendations

- NCERT Class XII - Themes in Indian History Part III (Understanding Partition / Towards Freedom).
- Spectrum's 'A Brief History of Modern India' by Rajiv Ahir (Chapter on Nationalist Response in the Wake of World War II).

Immediate Action Plan

1. [HIGH] Practice drawing rapid sketch maps of South-East Asia and India showing strategic military developments during WWII.

Impact: Enhances visual presentation and spatial clarity, fetching 1-1.5 extra marks in GS-1.

2. [MEDIUM] Memorize complete primary historical quotes and precise constitutional terms.

Impact: Eliminates vagueness and reflects rigorous factual standard expected by UPSC examiners.